Daily Economic Briefing

Wednesday 4 November 2026 | Window: Mon 2 Nov 2026 20:00 ET – Tue 3 Nov 2026 20:21 ET (Tue 3 Nov close/AH, the window's one NYSE session) | Research cutoff 8:21pm ET 3 Nov 2026 | Edition 56

60-second read

1. The Reserve Bank of Australia delivered its fifth hike of 2026 — 25bp to 4.85% — but for the first time this cycle on a split vote, 6-3, with three members preferring a hold.[7]
2. US equities diverged on composition again: the S&P 500 (+0.36%) and Nasdaq Composite (+0.83%) rose on a megacap/AI bounce even as the Dow fell 0.38% and AP's own wire noted most S&P 500 constituents actually declined on the session.[1][2]
3. AMD's fiscal Q3 beat-and-raise (revenue +45% y/y to $13.4bn, Q4 guide raised to approx. $17bn) sent shares up a further approx. 5% after hours — a rare case this earnings season of a clean beat actually holding up after the bell, unlike Apple, Intel, Oracle and Palantir's muted-to-negative reactions to their own recent reports.[5][6]
4. Oil stabilized after Monday's historic Iran-driven crash — WTI essentially flat (+0.13%), Brent off a further 1.12% — with no dated Tuesday-specific catalyst identified.[19]
5. December FOMC hike odds firmed further to approx. 74-75% (from approx. 72-73% at the prior edition) per Polymarket and DeFi Rate's blended aggregator, with a genuinely dense central-bank calendar still ahead (Riksbank Wed, BoE Thu).[8][9]

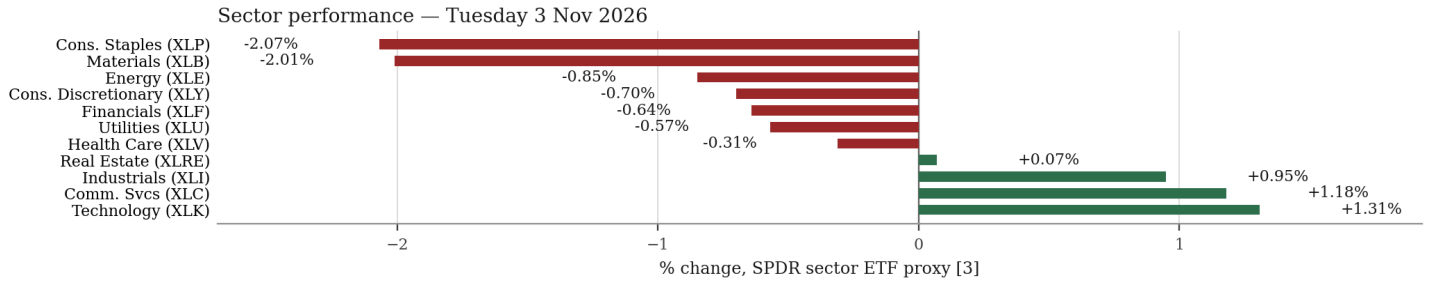
1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow	Nasdaq Comp.	Russell 2000	VIX	10Y Treasury
7,568.92	**51,786.72**	**25,372.01**	**2,812.45**	**20.83**	**4.95%**
+0.36%	-0.38%	+0.83%	+0.23%	-1.51%	+4bp

WTI crude	Gold	DXY	Bitcoin
$96.59	**$3,946.92**	**101.49**	**approx. $77,057**
+0.13%	-0.57%	-0.26%	little changed

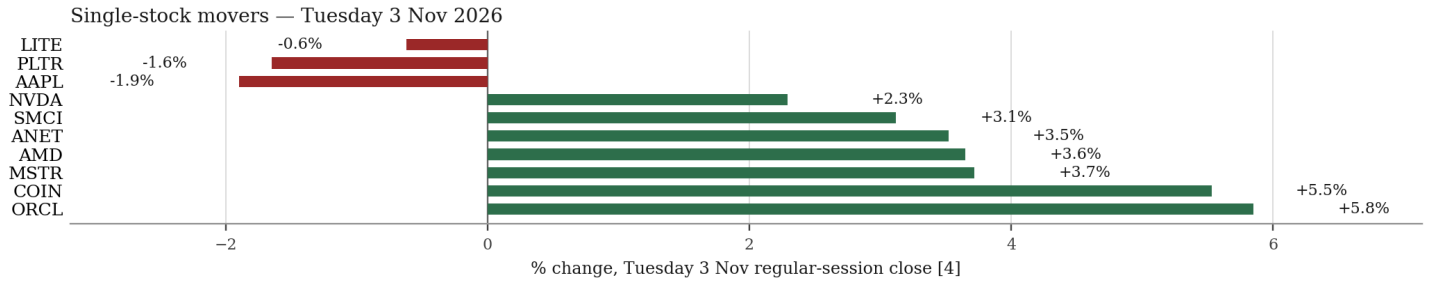
Equities diverged again on composition, not breadth. The S&P 500 rose 0.36% to 7,568.92 and the Nasdaq Composite rose 0.83% to 25,372.01, powered by a broad megacap/AI bounce (Nvidia +2.29%, Oracle +5.85%, Arista Networks +3.52%, Super Micro +3.12%) — even as the Dow fell 0.38% to 51,786.72 and AP's own wire noted most S&P 500 constituents actually declined on the session.[1][2] The Russell 2000 added 0.23% to 2,812.45.[1] Only 4 of 11 SPDR sector ETFs closed higher.[3]

Sector performance



Technology (XLK +1.31%), Communication Services (XLC +1.18%) and Industrials (XLI +0.95%) led, consistent with the session's megacap/AI bounce; Real Estate (XLRE) was roughly flat (+0.07%). The remaining seven sectors fell, led by Consumer Staples (XLP -2.07%) and Materials (XLB -2.01%), with Energy (XLE -0.85%), Consumer Discretionary (XLY -0.70%) and Financials (XLF -0.64%) also lower; no single dominant driver was identified for the Staples/Materials weakness despite a targeted search (Annex B).[3]

2. Equities and earnings



Ticker	Move	Driver
ORCL	+5.85%	Rebound after Monday's $20bn capex-raise-driven selloff (-8.76% Mon); no fresh Tuesday catalyst identified beyond stabilization[4]
COIN	+5.53%	Partial retracement of Monday's Binance-hack-driven selloff (-3.98% Mon)[4]
MSTR	+3.72%	Bitcoin-proxy bounce alongside Coinbase; Bitcoin little changed around $77,000[4]

AMD	+3.65% reg. / approx. +5.02% AH to $508.20	Regular close predated the print (broad AI-rally tailwind); Q3 beat-and-raise (rev. $13.4bn +45% y/y, non-GAAP EPS $2.09, Data Center +97% y/y, Q4 guide approx. $17bn) confirmed directly against AMD's own SEC 8-K drove the AH move[4][5][6]
ANET	+3.52%	Broader AI/networking bounce[4]
SMCI	+3.12%	Broader AI-hardware bounce[4]
NVDA	+2.29%	Lead name in the session's megacap/AI bounce[4]
AAPL	-1.90%	Extended Monday's post-earnings decline on a soft, secondary-sourced December-quarter margin outlook[1][4]
PLTR	-1.65%	Continued fading after Monday's -3.13% beat-and-raise reaction[4]
LITE	-0.62%	Further slight pullback after Monday's -18.59% acquisition-announcement plunge[4]

Intel (+0.97%) and Marvell (+0.33%) broadly stabilized with no fresh Tuesday-specific catalyst identified, following Monday's -8.80% and -12.72% moves respectively.[4] No analyst upgrade, downgrade or price-target change tied to today's movers could be independently verified by this edition's cutoff; a claimed Oracle analyst-upgrade note was investigated and rejected as unreliable (Annex A).

3. Macro, policy and rates

Central bank	Policy rate	Last change	Next decision
Federal Reserve	3.75%-4.00%	Held, 28 Oct 2026 (10-2, dissent Cook/Hammack)	8-9 Dec 2026
Reserve Bank of Australia	4.85%	Hiked 25bp, 3 Nov 2026 (6-3)	Not confirmed this edition (Annex B)
Bank of England	3.75%	Held, 17 Sept 2026 (6-3)	Thu 5 Nov 2026
Bank of Japan	approx. 1.25%	Held, 29-30 Oct 2026 (8-1)	17-18 Dec 2026
European Central Bank	2.50% / 2.65% / 2.90%	Held, 28-29 Oct 2026	Not confirmed (approx. mid-Dec by cadence)
Bank of Canada	2.50%	Hiked 25bp, 28 Oct 2026	9 Dec 2026
Swiss National Bank	0.00%	Held, most recent assessment 24 Sept 2026	10 Dec 2026
Norges Bank	4.50%	Held, 24 Sept 2026	17 Dec 2026
Riksbank	Unavailable (secondary: approx. 1.75%)	Secondary: held, effective date imprecise (previously cited 30 Sept 2026)	Wed 4 Nov 2026
Banxico	Unavailable (secondary: approx. 6.50%)	Secondary: cut 25bp, approx. 7 May 2026	Not confirmed (5 Nov cut rumor uncorroborated)

The RBA delivered its fifth hike of 2026, raising the cash rate 25bp to 4.85% — but for the first time this cycle on a split vote, 6-3, with three members preferring a hold.[7] December FOMC hike odds firmed to approx. 74-75% (hold approx. 23-24%, cut near zero) per a fresh Polymarket Gamma-API pull and DeFi Rate's blended aggregator, up from approx. 72-73% at the prior edition; DeFi Rate's own Kalshi rate-level sub-table continued running approx. 2-3 points above its headline hike figure, a narrower version of a recurring internal inconsistency.[8][9] Kalshi's own direct feed failed again (HTTP 429) and CME FedWatch again timed out — both continuing multi-edition failure streaks. No US government shutdown is in effect; H.R. 6500 continues to fund federal agencies through 11 December 2026, reconfirmed directly against whitehouse.gov.[10] On tariffs, a reciprocal-tariff suspension and Section 301 exclusions for 178 Chinese products are reported (secondary sourcing only) to run to approx. 9-10 November 2026, with no new Federal Register filing found this edition disclosing any extension.[18]

The Bank of England's 5 November decision date is now directly confirmed against bankofengland.co.uk, upgraded from secondary-only sourcing at the prior edition.[13] Riksbank's current rate value remains unconfirmable directly for a third straight edition (riksbank.se's own dedicated rate page 404'd again); its 4 November decision date stands.[11] Banxico's current rate and next-decision date also remain secondary-sourced only; an uncorroborated analyst note floated a possible 5 November cut, which could not be verified anywhere else and is reported here only as an unconfirmed rumor.[12] Wednesday's day-ahead calendar (Section 6) corrects an internal planning assumption that Caterpillar reports 4 November — it in fact already reported Q3 results on 29 October.[15]

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	$96.59	+0.13%	Stabilized after Monday's 7.36% Iran-driven crash[19]
Brent crude	$103.60	-1.12%	Further, milder pullback after Monday's 10.94% drop[19]
Henry Hub nat gas	$2.895	+1.40%	First clean two-source reconciliation (Investing.com, Yahoo Finance) in six editions[20]
Gold (futures)	$3,946.92	-0.57%	Kitco spot read +0.53% same session — disclosed conflict, not resolved[21][22]
Silver (futures)	$49.923	-1.90%	Kitco spot read +0.47% — same spot/futures conflict[21][22]
Copper (LME cash)	$14,110.50/t	-1.88%	COMEX cross-check agrees on direction (-2.39%)[23][24]
DXY (Yahoo DX-Y.NYB)	101.49	-0.26%	Investing.com futures-proxy read +0.10% (101.726) — unresolved, second straight edition[25][26]
EUR/USD	1.1194	+0.06%	[27]
GBP/USD	1.3415	+0.06%	[27]
USD/JPY	158.68	+0.46%	[27]
2Y Treasury	4.61%	+2bp	[28]
10Y Treasury	4.95%	+4bp	[28]
30Y Treasury	5.32%	+4bp	[28]

Oil stabilized after Monday's historic Iran-driven crash — WTI essentially flat (+0.13%) and Brent off a further 1.12% — with no dated Tuesday-specific catalyst identified beyond the market digesting Monday's move.[19] Henry Hub natural gas finally reconciled cleanly across two independent sources (Investing.com and Yahoo

Finance) for the first time in six editions, easing this report's longest-running single-series sourcing gap, at least for one day.[20] Gold and silver levels agreed closely across Kitco's spot quote and Investing.com's futures close, but the two sources disagreed on the sign of the day's move — spot readings showed both metals higher, futures settle-to-settle showed both lower — a disclosed, unresolved conflict rather than a vendor error.[21][22] The dollar-index conflict first logged last edition persisted a second straight session: Yahoo Finance's DX-Y.NYB ticker read the dollar softer (-0.26%) while an Investing.com futures-style DXY proxy read it firmer (+0.10%); the three major crosses (EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY) all ticked higher against the dollar, a modestly dollar-soft signal that sits closer to the Yahoo read.[25][26][27] Treasury yields rose modestly across the curve (2Y +2bp, 10Y +4bp, 30Y +4bp), confirmed against the official par-yield-curve TextView for a clean streak now running 22 straight editions.[28]

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The VIX complex eased across the board — VIX -1.51% to 20.83, VIX9D -2.23% to 21.96, VIX3M -1.53% to 21.27, VIX6M -1.59% to 22.31, VVIX -2.78% to 107.40, SKEW -1.81% to 150.01 — all independently hand-computed against the CBOE feed's own reported changes, which matched to the digit; neither of the feed's two known bugs (duplicated prev_day_close, mis-divided price_change_percent) appeared, a second straight clean edition.[29] Monday's term-structure kink (VIX9D above both VIX and VIX3M, short-end backwardation inside 30 days) narrowed but did not resolve: VIX9D's premium over VIX fell from 1.31 points to 1.13, and over VIX3M from 0.86 to 0.69; VIX3M-VIX6M stayed in its usual contango.[29] No third chart was used — the kink's narrowing, not resolution, was judged secondary to the session's RBA and AMD-earnings stories. No notable options-flow, skew or dealer-gamma commentary tied to AMD's pre-earnings positioning or the crypto-adjacent names could be verified to a reliable, dated source this edition (Annex B); zerogex.io and SpotGamma's dashboard both failed again, 17 and 11 consecutive editions respectively. No new CFTC Commitment of Traders data fell inside today's window, as expected — the next report is due Friday 6 November, covering Tuesday 3 November data; CFTC's own planned move to twice-weekly releases (announced 27 Oct) still has no confirmed start date.[16][17] Tuesday's SOFR/EFFR/OBFR funding prints could not be independently verified this edition (Annex B).

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Wed 4 Nov	Riksbank rate decision	Current rate approx. 1.75% (secondary-sourced only); no consensus figure located
Wed 4 Nov	Qualcomm FQ4/FY2026 earnings (after close)	Consensus not independently verified this edition[14]
Wed 4 Nov	ISM Services PMI (October)	Consensus unavailable (Annex B); September read was 54.9%
Thu 5 Nov	Bank of England rate decision	Current rate 3.75%; Monetary Policy Report also due[13]
Fri 6 Nov	October US employment report	Consensus not yet available (Annex B)
Fri 6 Nov	CFTC Commitment of Traders (covers Tue 3 Nov data)	Due 3:30pm ET; twice-weekly-release schedule change still has no confirmed start date[16]

Sector setup we take into Wednesday

- Energy: crude has stabilized after Monday's crash; a further Iran-US diplomatic development could move the sector either way.
- Technology/AI: AMD's strong beat-and-raise could extend Tuesday's megacap bounce, though AH gains have not reliably held into the next session this earnings cycle (Apple, Oracle, Palantir all faded or stayed muted after their own beats).
- Consumer Staples and Materials: Tuesday's laggards with no identified single-name driver — watch for a dated catalyst or further drift.
- Crypto-adjacent: Coinbase and Strategy bounced as Binance-hack fallout eased; still a live thread pending any fresh Binance recovery/regulatory update.
- Central-bank calendar: a genuinely dense multi-bank week ahead — Riksbank Wednesday, Bank of England Thursday, both still live decisions.

Annex A — Assumptions, corrections and status

- No correction box this edition — nothing published in a prior edition was found to be wrong.
- Bank of England's 5 November decision date upgraded to primary-sourced (bankofengland.co.uk) from secondary-only at the prior edition.
- Henry Hub natural gas reconciled across two independent sources for the first time in six editions (Investing.com, Yahoo Finance) — not yet enough to call the structural sourcing gap closed; watch next edition.
- VIX feed's two known bugs (duplicated prev_day_close; mis-divided price_change_percent) were absent for a second consecutive edition; the manual hand-computation discipline continues regardless of how many clean editions precede any given run.
- Gold/silver Monday baseline re-fetched this edition via Investing.com futures ($3,969.60 gold / $50.888 silver) differs by approx. 0.3-0.4% from the figure logged by the prior edition ($3,957.55 / $50.685) — a minor vendor-data variance, disclosed rather than treated as a repeat of the larger retroactive-revision pattern seen in earlier editions.
- A claimed Oracle analyst-upgrade note (citing "JPMorgan/Oppenheimer/Bernstein SocGen Group") was investigated and rejected as unreliable — internally inconsistent timestamps and a non-existent firm name — and is not reported in this edition, consistent with this report's standing single-aggregator-verification discipline.
- Kenvue (KVUE)'s apparent 2 Nov delisting, consistent with the pending Kimberly-Clark acquisition, could not be confirmed via a primary filing this edition (Annex B).
- The RBA's current rate (4.85%) and 6-3 vote are primary-confirmed; only its next decision date is unconfirmed this edition.
- Index closes, sector closes and single-stock closes were all independently cross-checked (AP mirror vs. ETF proxies; Monday baselines re-verified against the prior edition's own logged figures) with no disagreement of concern found on any of those series.

Annex B — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- RBA's next policy decision date (not found this edition).
- Riksbank's current policy-rate value (approx. 1.75%, secondary-sourced only; riksbank.se's own rate page 404'd for a third straight edition).
- Banxico's current policy rate (approx. 6.50%) and next-decision date (both secondary-sourced only); a 5 November cut rumor (Finamex/Bankaool) is uncorroborated.
- ECB's exact next Governing Council meeting date (unconfirmed, estimated mid-December by typical six-weekly cadence).
- October 2026 ISM Services PMI consensus figure (not found).
- AMD's pre-earnings implied move and options skew (conflicting, unreliable aggregator figures; excluded from the briefing).
- Dealer gamma (zerogex.io, SpotGamma) — both fully unusable again this edition.
- Tuesday 3 Nov SOFR/EFFR/OBFR funding prints (the NY Fed reference-rate page returned no live figure via direct fetch).
- A dated Tuesday-specific news driver for oil's stabilization, or for the Consumer Staples/Materials sector weakness — price moves confirmed, no driver identified for either.
- Kenvue/Kimberly-Clark deal's formal closing date (inferred only from a trading-data delisting, not primary-confirmed).
- Binance's Tuesday-specific recovery/regulatory status (no fresh update found beyond Monday's approx. 95%-covered figure).
- Analyst price-target changes tied to AMD, Intel or Marvell's recent reports/moves (not yet published by this edition's cutoff).
- The precise expiry date of the Section 301 exclusions/reciprocal-tariff suspension — secondary sources split between 9 and 10 November 2026.

Annex C — Sources

- [1] AP, "How major US stock indexes fared," mirrored via La Nación (lanacion.com.ar), 3 Nov 2026.
- [2] Stockanalysis.com, SPY/DIA/QQQ/IWM ETF price-history (cross-check), 3 Nov 2026.
- [3] Stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF price-history tables (all 11 sectors), 3 Nov 2026.
- [4] Stockanalysis.com, single-stock price-history tables, 3 Nov 2026.
- [5] AMD, Form 8-K Exhibit 99.1, SEC EDGAR, filed 3 Nov 2026.
- [6] Stockanalysis.com, live quote, AMD after-hours, approx. 7:59pm ET 3 Nov 2026.
- [7] Reserve Bank of Australia, "Statement by the Monetary Policy Board," Media Release 2026-30, rba.gov.au, 3 Nov 2026.
- [8] Polymarket, Gamma API (gamma-api.polymarket.com/public-search), snapshot approx. 8:24pm ET 3 Nov 2026.
- [9] DeFi Rate, Fed-decision odds aggregator, snapshot 7:30pm ET 3 Nov 2026.
- [10] The White House, briefing page on H.R. 6500, whitehouse.gov.
- [11] Riksbank rate value and decision-date, secondary corroboration (Continuum Economics, MNI Markets, financecalendar.com, forexfundamentals.com).
- [12] Banxico rate/decision, secondary corroboration (Zeta Tijuana, Ámbito, El CEO/Finamex-Bankaool note).
- [13] Bank of England, "Upcoming MPC dates," bankofengland.co.uk.
- [14] Qualcomm, investor-relations press release, qualcomm.com.
- [15] Caterpillar, Q3 2026 earnings release / Form 8-K, SEC EDGAR, 29 Oct 2026.
- [16] CFTC, Press Release 9316-26, cftc.gov, 27 Oct 2026.
- [17] CFTC, financial_lf.htm futures-only positions page, cftc.gov, checked 3 Nov 2026.
- [18] Secondary trade-law bulletin reporting on Section 301 exclusion/reciprocal-tariff-suspension expiry (approx. 9-10 Nov 2026); no primary Federal Register filing located this edition.
- [19] Investing.com, crude oil (WTI/Brent) historical data tables.
- [20] Investing.com and Yahoo Finance (NG=F), natural gas historical data, cross-checked.
- [21] Kitco, live spot quotes, gold and silver, approx. 8:22-8:24pm ET 3 Nov 2026.
- [22] Investing.com, gold/silver futures historical data tables.
- [23] Westmetall.com, LME copper cash/3-month settlement, 3 Nov 2026.
- [24] Investing.com, COMEX copper historical data (secondary cross-check).
- [25] Yahoo Finance, DX-Y.NYB historical data.
- [26] Investing.com, US Dollar Index historical data table.
- [27] Investing.com, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY historical data tables.
- [28] US Department of the Treasury, Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates (TextView), home.treasury.gov.
- [29] CBOE, delayed-quotes JSON feed (cdn.cboe.com / cdn-api.cboe.com), 3 Nov 2026.

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex C; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex B. Not investment advice.